

Great Expectations for the Wolkovich Lab

August 11, 2026

1 Why are you giving me this?

The Temporal Ecology Lab (aka ‘the Wolkovich lab’) is fortunate enough to be a pretty happy, productive and efficient place to be most of the time (IMHO). The reason for this is the people—who are generally amazing team members.

Sometimes, how to be an amazing team member is not obvious to everyone though. So to be clear, I have written up a list of what I expect. Most of these tasks should be easy for you, and effectively are my way of explaining what I see as a good lab member. That said, everyone is different and many things can come up over someone’s time in the lab, so think of these as general guidelines and if you find times in your career you cannot meet all the expectations—just reach out to me (Lizzie) to discuss.

2 Lab expectations

- Be aware of and follow our general lab values.
- Attend lab meetings (when we have them).
- Attend scrum (when we have it) and give weekly updates.
- Follow the lab’s data management plan, including how you manage metadata and in backing up all your data.
- Schedule meetings with Lizzie as needed. Please ask for help when you need it.
- Plan for a usual two-week turnaround on grants, drafts, letters etc. given to or requested from Lizzie. Depending on the request and Lizzie’s schedule it could be longer.
- Exploit the seminar and discussion group resources around you. Aim to attend at least one talk a week of the following: BRC (Wednesdays at noon); Faculty of Forestry Seminar series (not every week, but Tuesdays at noon); Forest & Conservation Sciences; Botany Seminar Series (Tuesdays at 12:30)
- Attend all talks by lab-invited speakers and sign up to meet with them.
- Help out as requested in the lab. The lab has a variety of resources/events that make the lab happier and more productive but keeping these things running requires small commitments from all lab members.

During your time in the lab you’ll be asked to pitch in on various lab tasks and manage various resources. Some examples include: keeping the lab vehicle on top of its inspections

and helping with annual reimbursement; managing the lab website and GitHub; help collect long-term lab data; helping design, collect seeds or aid plantings for the common garden/field sites; bring snacks to lab meeting, helping schedule invited speakers, etc.. Please help when asked to contribute to keeping the lab running well.

- Help out in other ways, not always requested, but needed in the lab. If you see something that needs doing (e.g., scheduling a lab cleanup day, or getting gas for the grills before a BBQ), please offer to do it, or just do it (depending on what it is).
- Share your skills and knowledge and be open to learning from your peers.
- Write your documents in **LaTeX** (or txt or rtf for quicker documents).
- Organize all code with **git** and use github to share code.
- Check in with Lizzie before booking your field season travel (and other major travel), and add it to the lab calendar. Be sure to clearly share your dates and get them approved by Lizzie before booking.
- Adjust your schedule to make yourself the most productive (and hopefully) efficient, but plan to be in the office most days of the mid-week when not in the field.
- Check before you schedule holiday time or beyond a few days (be sure to clearly share your dates and get them approved by Lizzie) and be sure to add it to the lab calendar.
- Follow lab guidelines on writing.
- Follow lab guidelines on the use of generative AI and disclosure of your use of it more broadly.
- Share lab resources well. If multiple people need the same resource try to make it work, and if you plan to monopolize a resource for a while, bring it up at scrum first.
- Back up your computer! Check out the guidelines. (Help Lizzie update this as needed.)
- Buy a monitor—there is generally \$400 CAD available for monitors and peripherals available to graduate students in the lab if there are no good spare ones in the lab to use (check with Lizzie first).
- Be productive and happy! Look for ways to make the lab a better place for others and suggest ways to make it better for you.